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HRRP BULLETIN

Third Anniversary of the Gorkha Earthquake

26 April 2018

Yesterday we took the time to remember everyone affected by the Gorkha Earthquake, especially the nearly 9,000 people that lost their life, and the more than 22,000 people injured. Thirty-two districts were directly affected by the earthquake, but the impact has been felt across the whole country. The key figures, as of 15 April, are as follows:

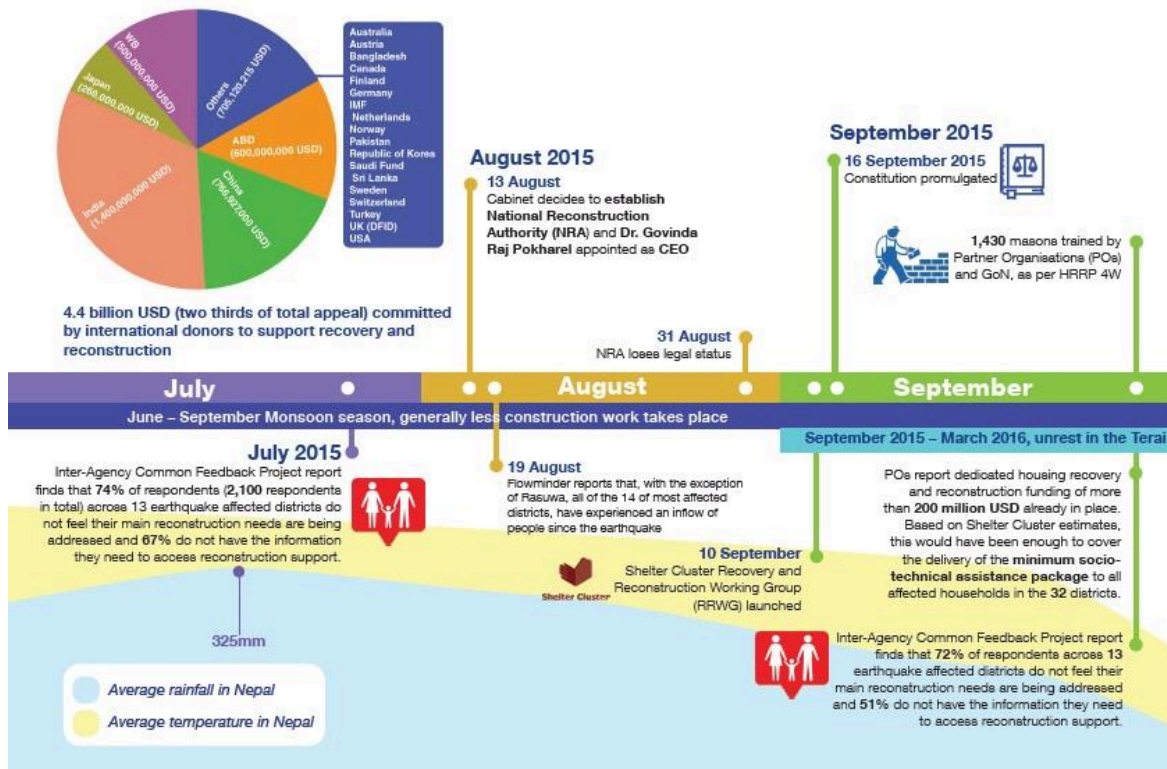
- 767,705 households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant of 300,000 NPRs
- 25,012 households eligible for the GoN housing retrofit grant of 100,000 NPRs
- 714,148 households with grant agreement
- 699,387 households received first tranche of 50,000 NPRs
- 319,012 households received second tranche of 150,000 NPRs (reconstruction grant), no households eligible for the retrofit grant have received the second and final tranche of 50,000 NPRs
- 87,253 households have received the third tranche of 100,000 NPRs

The HRRP has prepared a [timeline to illustrate the path that housing reconstruction to date](#). The timeline highlights that there is limited time during the year when construction is possible as a result of winter and monsoon. This emphasises the enormous efforts by people at all levels, but most of all those in earthquake affected communities, required to reach the point we are at now.

2015



2015



2015

October 2015

DUDBC Design Catalogue Volume 1 is published. The catalogue states "It is not mandatory for households to select a design from this catalogue, and they are free to prepare house designs outside of the catalogue but these designs must comply with the National Building Code".



December 2015

25 December

Mr. Sushil Gyawali appointed as CEO

21 December

Reconstruction Act 2072 issued and NRA's Policy Act formed

October

November

December

October 2015 – March 2016: Winterisation support of 10,000 NPRs in cash or in-kind support provided based on Shelter Cluster guidance.
September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai and blockade at the borders



Phase 1 of Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) is launched, led by IOM and UN Habitat, taking over responsibility for supporting the coordination of the housing recovery and reconstruction efforts from the Nepal Earthquake Shelter Cluster.



115 Partner Organisations reporting emergency as for shelter cluster 4w

PO

31 December



The Nepal Shelter Cluster reverts to its pre-earthquake format as a standing cluster with focus on preparedness and contingency planning

14°C

64mm

2016

January 2016

15 January
Start of CBS Detail
Damage Assessment



March 2016

13 March 2016
A pilot enrolment is held in Singati, Dolakha, for households from Lamidada and Laduk VDCs.

31 March

Cabinet approved NRA NGO Mobilisation Guidelines are launched.

15 January - 20 June: A Detailed Damage Assessment is conducted by the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS), to determine eligibility for the GoN housing reconstruction grant in 11 of the most affected districts (not including the three Kathmandu Valley districts). 762,106 households are surveyed using a census model in which each household is visited and assessed by a trained enumerator.

January

February

March

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai and blockade at the borders

BBC Media Action research finds that the most reported sources of information are radio (67%), television (57%), people in the local neighbourhood (47%), friends (43%), and family (40%), with the most trusted sources of information being friends and family (90%), local chiefs or village elders (93%), radio (90%), and television (87%).



62 Partner Organisations supporting housing reconstruction as per HRRP 4W

PO

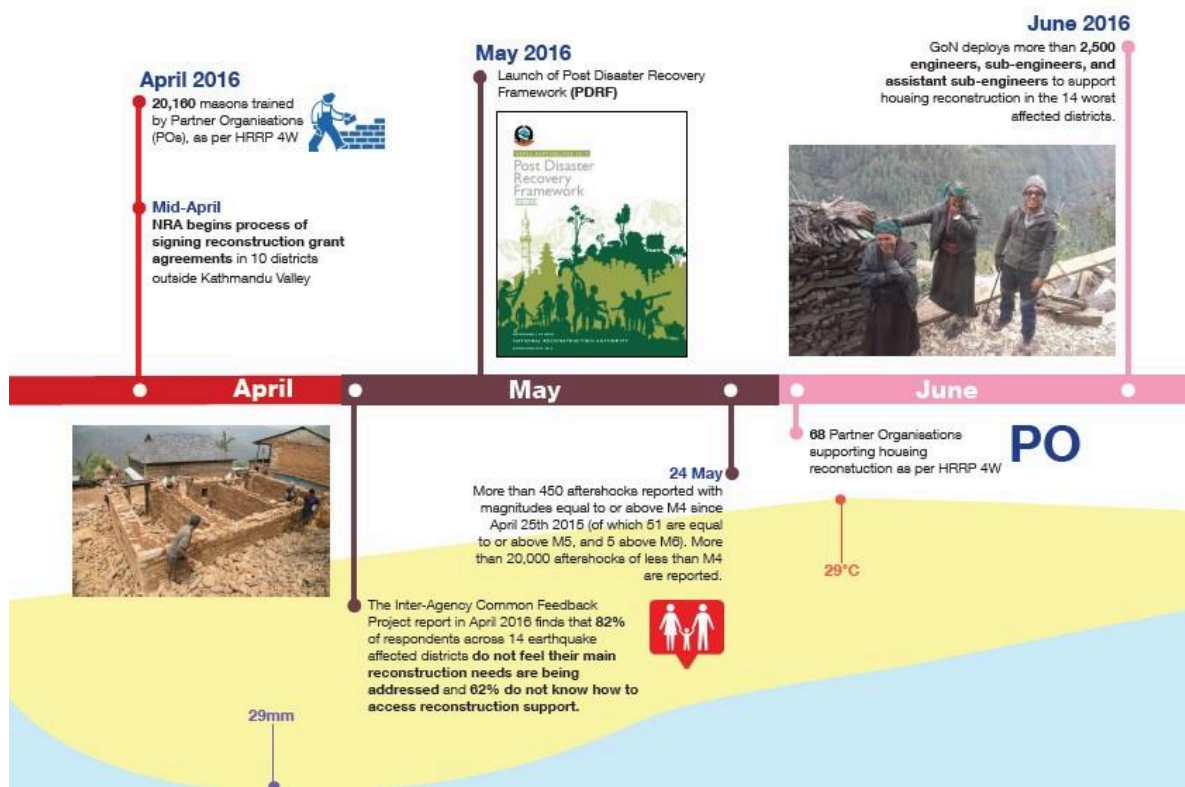
Average rainfall in Nepal

Average temperature in Nepal

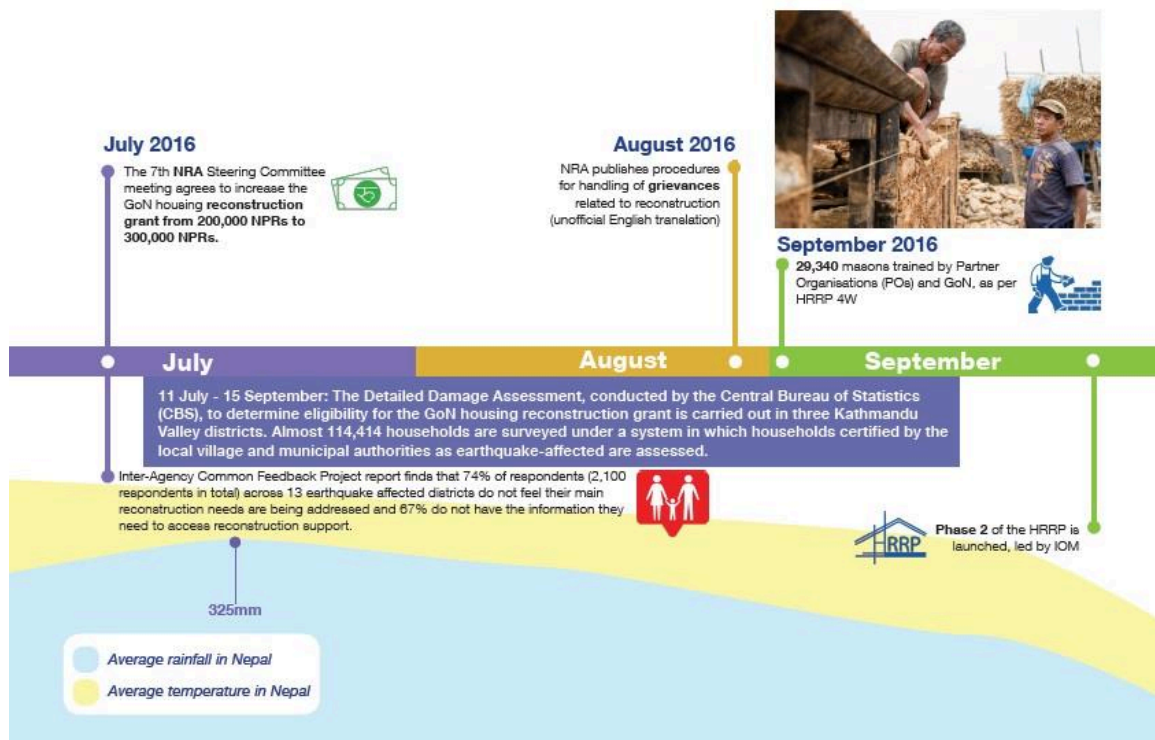
14mm

24°C

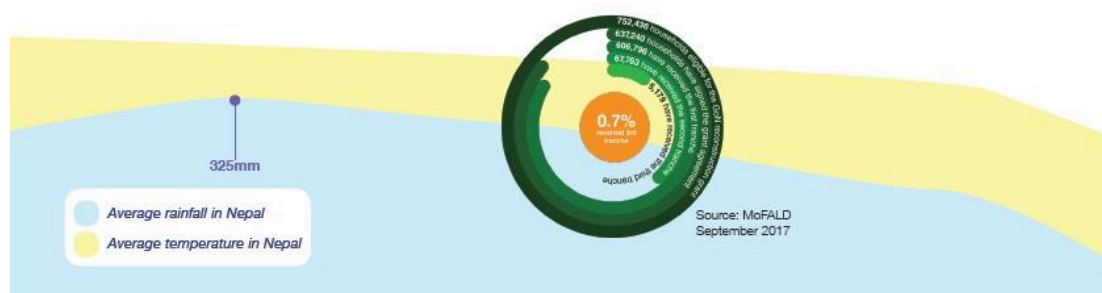
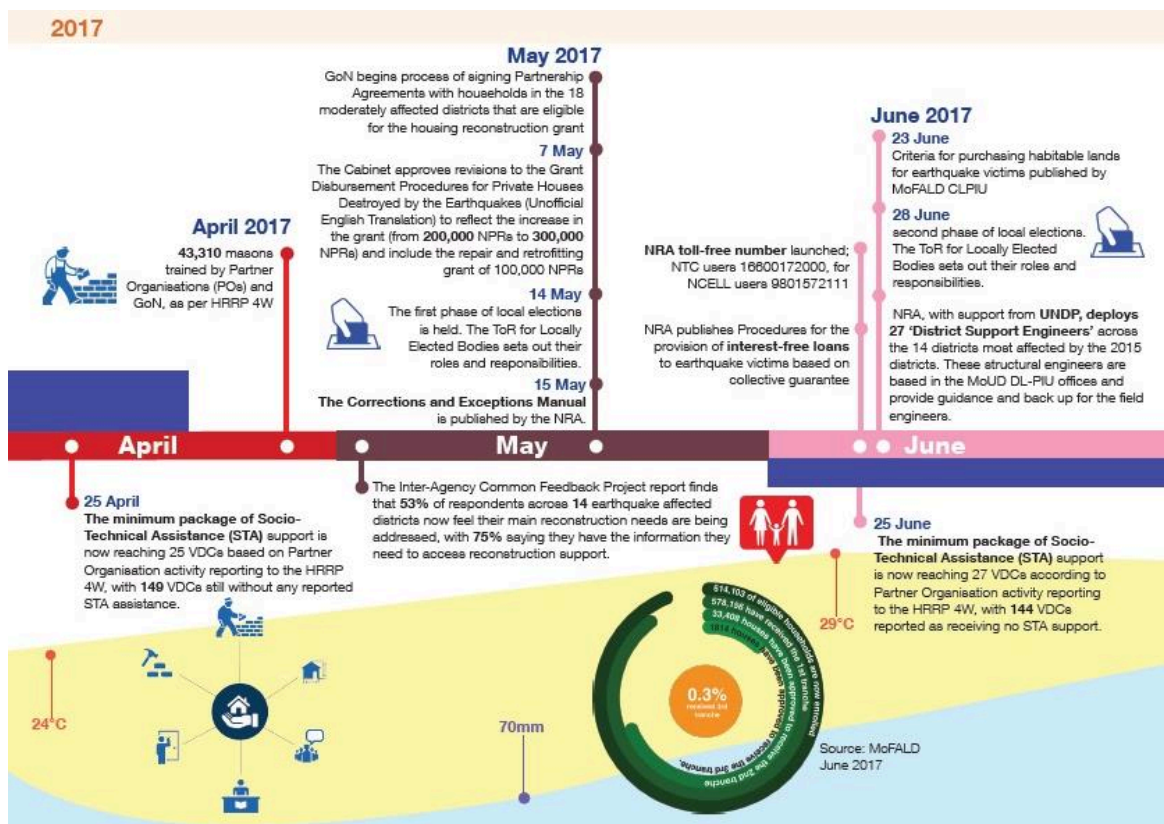
2016

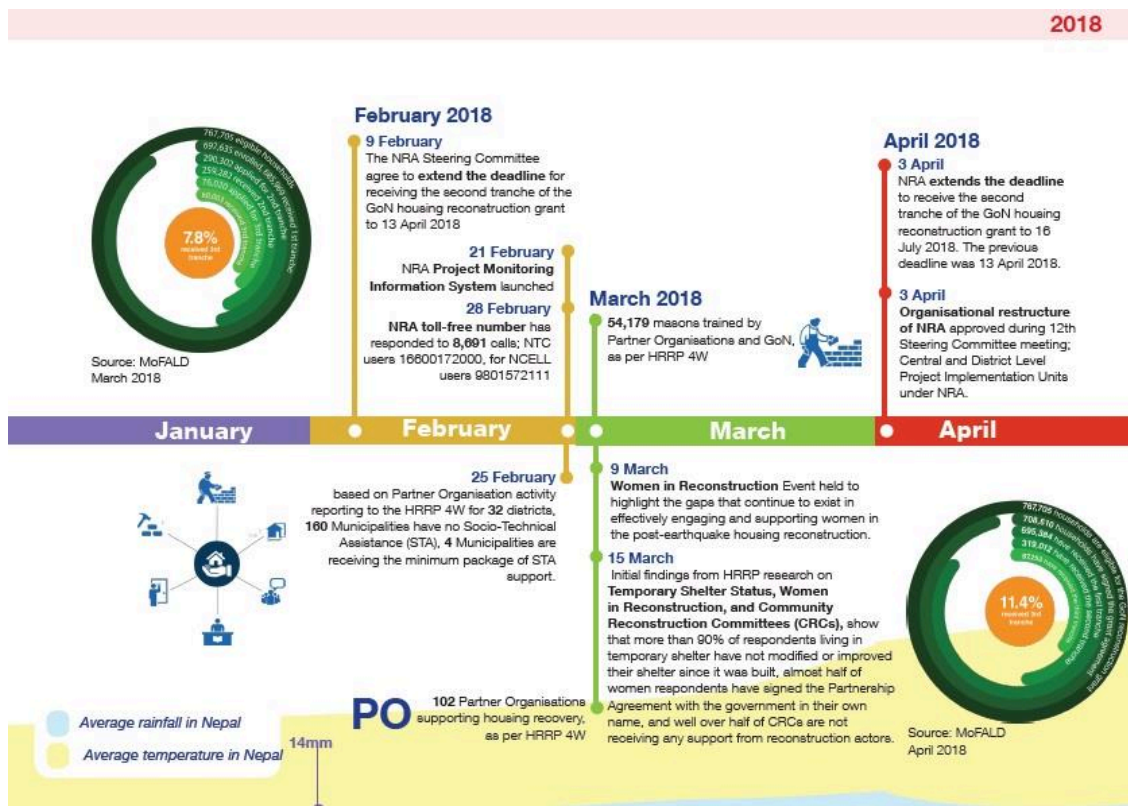
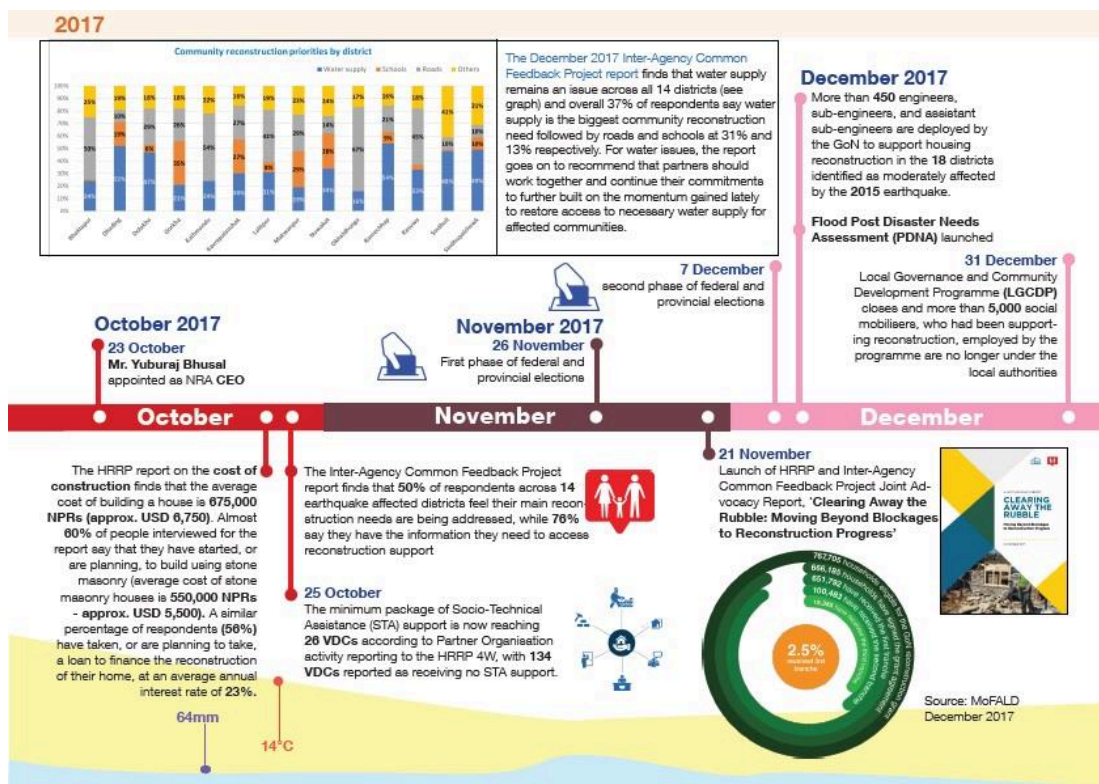


2016









There have been many lessons learnt from the housing recovery process so far and, to be prepared and reduce risk and strengthen resilience for future disaster and avoid casualties, we must learn from the efforts of the last three years and carry this forward in the years ahead to the completion of safer housing reconstruction. Moving forward additional support is specifically required for:

- **Scaled up door to door socio-technical assistance:** intensive socio-technical support, with more than 6 visits by a mobile support team at times convenient to the households, is required at scale and with special consideration of targeted support for vulnerable households and those who have not yet started building.
- **Support for socio-technical assistance field staff:** regular training, orientation, and back stopping support is required to ensure that socio-technical assistance field staff can effectively support households, masons, vendors / producers, and local officials with all aspects of the reconstruction process.
- **Support for elected officials at municipal and ward level:** the newly elected officials have an important role to play in the reconstruction but without sufficient training, orientation, and information sharing this is very challenging.
- **Engage construction material suppliers and producers as agents of technical assistance:** suppliers and producers represent fixed points of reference for households and communities, where they can access information and guidance regarding materials and their use for construction. Local technical support should include the mobilisation of vendors and fabricators as partners in the promotion of awareness of the importance of quality assurance in safer construction. It is important to build solidarity and collective responsibility to the community in terms of achieving and maintaining standards.
- **Improve the engagement of women in reconstruction:** to date women have been consistently left behind, improving socio-technical assistance, and involving local women in socio-technical assistance teams, would make a difference in this area. To support women, socio-technical assistance needs to follow their time schedule. Also running women only mason trainings and supporting peer-to-peer sharing between women masons and women interested in masonry or just managing construction of their own home may be useful.
- **Assess and address water supply issues:** a long running issue in the reconstruction, more detailed assessment is required to understand the specific water supply issues faced in different communities and to plan appropriate solutions.
- **Additional support for vulnerable households:** in the form of ‘top-ups’ to the grants (as cash or in-kind and up to a value of 50,000 NPRs) where funding allows, and with increased, targeted socio-technical assistance.

Events Marking the Anniversary

Launch of NRA Photo Exhibition and Minute Silence, 25 April: the National Reconstruction Authority launched a 4 day photo exhibition at the NRA central office, Singha Durbar Kathmandu to mark the third anniversary of the 2015 Gorkha Earthquake. The NRA Deputy Spokesperson, Mr. Bhishma Kumar Bhusal, facilitated a minute silence in memory of all those who lost their lives during the earthquake in the presence of government, partner, and European Union representatives. The NRA also organised a press meet where the reconstruction progress, status, and plans were [presented](#).



Photos on display at the NRA photo exhibition to mark the third anniversary of the Gorkha Earthquake in Singha Durbar.

Nepal Red Cross Society (NRCS) Event, 25 April: the event started with an exhibition covering each of the components of the NRCS Earthquake Response Operation (ERO); shelter, Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH), health, livelihoods, and institutional capacity building. The exhibition was followed by a formal stakeholder meeting where the head of the ERO presented an update on the progress under each component, as well as on thematic areas including Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) and Community Engagement and Accountability (CEA). The stakeholder meeting also included a screening of a documentary on NRCS activities. During the meeting, the Head of IFRC stated that the Red Cross Movement is now transitioning from the final phase of earthquake recovery and reconstruction to sustainable long term development programming. The exhibition and meeting was attended by various Red Cross Movement partners, government officials, and I/NGO representatives.



NRCS stakeholder meeting (L) and exhibition (R).

HRRP District Exhibition and General Meeting, 23 April: many thanks to everyone that attended the event. The materials shared at the exhibition stalls are available here:

- [Dhading](#)
- [Dolakha](#)
- [Gorkha](#)
- [Kathmandu Valley](#)
- [Kavrepalanchok](#)
- [Makwanpur](#)
- [Nuwakot](#)
- [Okhaldhunga](#)
- [Ramechhap](#)
- [Rasuwa](#)
- [Sindhuli](#)
- [Sindhupalchok](#)
- [18 Districts](#)
- [National](#)
- [Common Feedback Project](#)
- [BBC Media Action](#)
- [Durable Solutions](#)

The HRRP presentation from the general meeting is available [here](#) and photos and videos from the event are available on the HRRP [Facebook](#) and [Twitter](#). A full report will be shared shortly and a HRRP press release which includes some coverage of the event is available [here](#). HRRP would also like to acknowledge that the event – as well as previously shared feedback – highlighted the need for the platform to provide increased focus on working with implementing agencies to identify good practices and share details of modalities that have a positive impact on the reconstruction and enable households who have limited capacity to reconstruct. We will be working with partners on this moving forward.



HRRP district exhibition (L) and general meeting (R).

JICA Photo Exhibition, 20-23 April: to commemorate the third anniversary of the Gorkha Earthquake 2015, JICA Nepal held a four day photo exhibition, with the theme “Building Resilient Nepal”, to showcase the wide range of JICA’s recovery and reconstruction efforts in Nepal. The exhibition highlighted the progress and achievements made in the last three years and aimed to promote awareness and understanding of JICA’s support based on the ‘Build Back Better’ principle. The exhibition was jointly inaugurated at a formal ceremony by Mr. Yubraj Bhusal, Chief Executive Officer, National Reconstruction Authority and Mr. Jun Sakuma, Chief Representative, JICA Nepal.



NRA CEO, Mr. Yubraj Bhusal, at the JICA photo exhibition.

Media Coverage

[‘Nepal's female masons dig deep to lay foundations for change and renewal’, The Guardian, 25 April](#)

[‘Nepal's Desperate Race to Rebuild’, The Diplomat, 25 April](#)

[‘Quake-hit Sindhupalchowk getting new lease of life’, My Republica, 25 April](#)

[‘Devolving Delivery’, Nepali Times, 25 April](#)

[‘Reconstruction delayed as quake-victims await second tranche of housing grant’, The Himalayan Times, 25 April](#)

[‘Rebuilding right way’, My Republica, 25 April](#)

[‘Quake recovery hits new hurdle: Survivors building 1-room homes’, Kathmandu Post, 24 April](#)

[‘Nepal: Rising from the Devastating 2015 Earthquake’, People in Need](#): an interactive ‘story map’, which provides photos, videos, and stories from areas where People in Need implemented earthquake recovery programming.

[‘Past disasters foretold’, Nepali Times, 20 April](#)

[‘How prepared are we for the next big one?’, Nepali Times, 20 April](#)

[‘It’s all in the mind’, Nepali Times, 20 April](#)

[‘Bhaktapur’s Miracle boy at 3’, Nepali Times, 20 April](#)

[‘1/3 empty or 2/3 full?’, Nepali Times, 20 April](#)

[‘Reconstruction and resilience’, Nepali Times, 20 April](#)

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